

A mery Dia-

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nest wyues, not onelie verie
pleasaunte, but also not a
lytle profitable: made
by þe famous clerke

D. Erasmus

Roteroda-

mus.

Translated into

Englyshe.



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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A MERRY
DIALOGUE DECLARINGE THE PROPERTIES OF SHROWDE SHREWS
AND HONEST WIVES ***

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Anno. M.CCCCC.
LVII.

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Eulalia. God spede, & a thousand mine old acquaintance. xantippa.

xan. As many agayn, my dere hert. Eulalia. me semets ye ar warē much faire now of late.

Eula. Saye you so? gyue you me a mocke at the first dash.

xan. Nay veryly but I take you so.

Eula. Happely mi new gown maketh me to loke fayrer then I sholde doe.

xan. Sothe you saye, I haue not sene a mynioner this many dayes, I reken it Englishe cloth.

Eu. It is english stuff and dyed in Venis.

xan. It is softer then sylke what an oriente purpel colore here is who gaue you so rich a gift.

Eu. How shoulde honeste women come by their gere? but by their husbandes.

xā. Happy arte thou that hathe suche an husband, but I wolde to god for his passyon, that I had maryed an husband of clowts, when I had married col my good mā.

Eula. Why say ye so. I pray you, are you at oddes now.

xā. I shal neuer be at one w^t him ye se how beggerly I go. I haue not an hole smock to put on my backe, and he is wel contente with all: I praye god I neuer come in heuen & I be not ashamed oftymes to shewe my head, when I se other wiues how net and trim they go that ar matched with farre porer mē then he is.

Eula. The apparell of honest wiues is not in the aray of the body, nor in the tirements of their head as saynte Peter the apostle teacheth vs (and that I learned a late at a sermon) but in good lyuyng and honest conuersacion and in the ornamentes of the soule, the cōmon buenes ar painted up, to please manye mennes eies we ar trime ynough yf we please our husbands only.

xan. But yet my good man so euyll wylling to bestow ought vpon his wyfe, maketh good chere, and lassheth out the dowrye that hee hadde with mee no small pot of wine.

Eulaly, where vpon?

xantipha, wheron hym lykethe beste, at the tauerne, at the stewes and at the dyce.

Eulalia Peace saye not so.

xan. wel yet thus it is, then when he cōmeth home to me at midnight, longe watched for, he lyeth rowtyng lyke a sloyne all the leue longe nyght, yea and now and thē he all bespeweth his bed, and worse then I will say at this tyme.

Eulali. Peace thou dyshonesteth thy self, when thou doest dishonesteth thy husbād.

xantip. The deuyll take me bodye and bones but I had leuer lye by a sow with pigges, then with suche a bedfelowe.

Eulali. Doest thou not then take him vp, wel favoredly for stūbling.

Xantip. As he deserueth I spare no tonge.

Eulalia. what doth he thē.

xantip. At the first breake he toke me vp vengeably, trusting that he shoulde haue shakē me of and put me to scilence with his crabid wordes.

Eula Came neuer your hote wordes vnto hād-strokes.

xantip. On a tyme we fel so farre at wordes y^t we wer almost by y^e eares togither.

Eula what say you womā?

xan. He toke vp a staffe wandryng at me, as the deuill had bene on hym ready to laye me on the bones.

Eula. were thou not redye to ron in at the bēch hole.

xanti. Nay mary I warrant the. I gat me a thre foted stole in hand, & he had but ones layd his littell finger on me, he shulde not haue founde me lame. I woulde haue holden his nose to the grindstōe

Eulalia. A newe found shelde, ye wanted but youre dystaffe to haue made you a speare.

xantip. And he shoulde not greatlye a laughed at his parte.

Eulali. Ah my frynde. xantypa. that way is neither good nor godly,

xantippa what is neither good nor godly. yf he wyll not vse me, as hys wyfe: I wil not take him for my husbāde.

Eulalya. But Paule sayeth that wyues shoulde bee boner and buxome vnto their husbādes with all humylytye, and Peter also bryngethe vs an example of Sara, that called her husbāde Abrahame, Lorde.

xantippa. I know that as well as you thē y^e same paule say that men shoulde loue theyr wyues, as Christ loues his spouse the church let him do his duete I wil do myne.

Eula. But for all that, when the matter is so farre that the one muste forber the other it is reason that the woman giue place vnto the man,

xan. Is he meete to be called my husbāde that maketh me his vnderlynge and his dryuel?

Eula. But tel me dame xātip. Would he neuer offre the stripes after that

xātip. Not a stripe, and therin he was the wyser man for & he had he should haue repented euery vayne in hys harte.

Eulali. But thou offered him foule wordes plentie,

xantip. And will do.

Eula. What doth he y^e meane seasō.

xantip. What doth he sometyme cowcheth an hogeshed, sometime he doth nothing but stande and laughe at me, other whyle takethe hys Lute wheron is scarslie three strynges layenge on that as fast as he may dryue because he would not here me.

Eula. Doeth that greue thee?

xantippa. To beyonde home, manie a tyme I haue much a do to hold my handes.

Eula. Neighbour. xantip. wylt thou gyue me leaue to be playn with the.

xantippa Good leaue haue you.

Eula. Be as bolde on me agayne our olde acquayntaunce and amite, euen frō our chyldhode, would it should be so.

xantippa. Trueth you saie, there was neuer woman kinde that I fauoured more

Elaly Whatsoeuer thy husbād be, marke well this, chaunge thou canst not, In the olde lawe, where the deuill hadde cast aboone betwene the man and the wife, at the worste waye they myght be deuorsed, but now that remedie is past, euē till death depart you he must nedes be thy husbāde, and thou hys wyfe,

xan. Il mote they thryue & thei that taken away that liberty from vs

Eulalia. Beware what thou sayest, it was christes act.

Xā. I can euil beleue that

Eula. It is none otherwyse, now it is beste that eyther of you one beyng with an other, ye laboure to liue at reste and peace.

xantypa. Why? can I forgeue him a new,

Eu. It lieth great parte in the womē, for the orderinge of theyr husbādes.

xan. Leadest thou a mery life with thine.

Eula Now all is well.

xan. Ergo ther was somewhat to do at your fyrste metying

Eula. Neuer no greate busynes, but yet as it, happeneth now and than betwene man & womā, there was foule cloudes a loft, that might haue made a storme but that they were ouer blowen with good humanitie and wyse handlynge. Euery man hath hys maner and euery mā hath his seueral aptite or mynde, and

thinks hys owne way best, & yf we list not to lie there liueth no mā without faulte, which yf anie were elles, ywis in wedlocke they ought to know and not vtterly hated

xan, you say well,

Eulalya. It happeneth many times that loue dayes breketh betwene man and wife, before y^e one be perfittly knowē vnto the other beware of that in any wife, for when malice is ones begon, loue is but barely redressed agayne, namely, yf the mater grow furthe unto bytter checkes, & shamfull raylinges such things as are fastened with glew, yf a manne wyll all to shake them strayght waye whyle the glew is warme, they soone fal in peces, but after y^e glew is ones dried vp they cleue togither so fast as anie thing, wherefore at the beginning a meanes must be made, that loue mai encrease and be made sure betwene y^e man & the wife, & that is best brought aboute by gentillesse and fayre condycions, for the loue that beautie onelie causeth, is in a maner but a cheri faire

Xan. But I praye you hartelye tell me, by what pollycy ye brought your good man to folow your daunce.

Eula. I wyll tell you on this condicyon, that ye will folowe me.

xan. I can.

Eula, It is as easy as water if ye cā find in your hart to do it, nor yet no good time past for he is a yong mā, and you ar but agirle of age, and I trowe it is not a yere ful sins ye wer married.

Xā All thys is true

Eulalia. I wyll shew you then. But you must kepe it secret

xantip. with a ryght good wyl.

Eula. This was my chyefe care, to kepe me alwayes in my housbandes fauoure, that there shulde nothyng angre him I obserued his appetite and pleasure I marked the tymes bothe whan he woulde be pleased and when he wold be all byshrwd, as they tameth the Elephantes and Lyons or suche beastes that can not be wonne by strēgh

xantyppa. Suche a beaste haue I at home.

Eula. Thei that goth vnto the Elephantes weare no white garmentes, nor they that tame wylde bulles, weare no blasyng reedes, for experience teacheth, that suche beastes bee madde with those colours, like as the Tygers by the sound of tumbrels be made so wode, that thei plucke theymsel in peces. Also thei y^t breake horses haue their termes and theyr soundes theyr hadlynges, and other knackes to breake their wyldnes, wyth all. Howe much more then is it oure duetyes that y^e wyues to use suche craftes toward our husbandes with whō all our lyfe tyme wil we, nyl we is one house, and one bed.

xantip. furthwith your tale.

Eula, whē I had ones marked there thynges. I applied my selfe unto hym, well ware not to displease him.

xantip. How could thou do that.

Eulalya. Fyrste in the ouerseynge my householde, which is the very charge and cure of wyues, I wayted euer, not onely gyuyng hede that nothing shoulde be forgotten or undoone, but that althynges should be as he woulde haue it, wer it euer so small a trifle.

xā. wherin.

Eulalia. As thus. Yf mi good man had a fantasye to this thyng, or to that thyng, or if he would haue his meate dressed on this fashion, or that fashion.

xan. But howe couldest thou fashyon thye selfe after hys wyll and mynde, that eyther woulde not be at home or elles be as freshe as a saulte heryng.

Elali. Abyde a while. I come not at that yet, yf my husband wer very sad at anye tyme, no time to speake to him. I laughed not nor tryfled him as many a woman doth but I looked rufully and heauyly, for as a glasse (if it be a true stone) representeth euer y^e physnamy of hym that loketh in it, so lykewyse it becommeth a wedded woman alway to agre vnto the appetite of her husbande, that she be not mery whē he murneth, nor dysposed to play whē he is sad. And if that at any time he be waiward shrewshaken, either I pacyfye hym with faire wordes, or I let hym alone, vntyll the wynd be ouerblowen gyuing him neuer a

word at al, vntil the time come that I may eyther excuse my faute, or tell hym of hys. In lyke wyse when he commeth home wel whitled, I gyue hym gentyll and fayre woordes, so with fayre entreatynge I gette hym to bed.

xantypa. O careful state of wyues, whē they muste be gladde and fayne to followe their husbandes mindes, be thei eluyshe, dronken, or doying what myschiefe they liste.

Eula. As whoe saieth this gentill dealyng serueth not for bothe partyes, for they spyte of theyr berdes muste suffre many thynges in our demeanor, yet a time ther is, whē in a weighty matter it is lafull that the wyfe tell the good mā his faute, if that it be matter of substaunce, for at lyght trifles, it is best to play byll under wynges.

xantyp. what tune is that

Eula. when he is ydle, neither angry, pensife, nor ouersen, then betwixt you two secretly he must be told his faute gētly, or rather intreated, that in this thyng or that he play the better husbāde to loke better to his good name and fame and to his helth and this tellyng must be myxt with mery conceites and pleasaunt wordes many times I make a meane to tel my tale after this fashyon, that he shall promise me, he shal take no displeasure wyth my thyng, that I a foolyshe woman shall breake vnto hym, that pertayneth eyther to hys helthe worshyppe or welth. When I haue sayde that I woulde, I chop cleane from that communication and falle into some other pastime, for this is all our fautes, neyghbour Xantippa, that whē we begyn ones to chat our tounses neuer lie.

Xantip. So men say

Eulalia. Thus was I well ware on, that I neuer tell my husbād his fautes before companie, nor I neuer caried any cōplaynte furthe a dores: the mendes is soner made whē none knoweth it but two, and there were anie suche faute that myght not be wel borne nor amēded by y^e wyues tellige, it is more laudable that the wife make complaynte vnto the Parentes and kynsfolke of her husband, then vnto her own, and so to moderate her complaynte that she seme not to hate hym but hys vice nor let her play all the blabbe, that in some poynt vnuterred, he may know & loue his wiues curteysy.

Xantip. She had nede be aswellerned womā, that would do all this.

Eu. Mary through suche demeanoure, we shall sterre our husbādes vnto lyke gentylnesse.

Xan: There be some that cannot be amended with all the gentyll handlynge in the worlde.

Eula: In faith I thyncke nay, but case there be, marke this wel the good man must be for borne, howe soeuer the game goeth, then is it better to haue him alwayes at one point or ells more kinde and louing throw oure gentill handlinge, then to haue him worse and worse throwe our cursednesse, what wyll you say and I tell you of husbādes that hath won theyr wiues by suche curtesie, howe muche more are we boūde to use the same towarde our husbandes.

Xantip. Than shall you tell of one farre vnlyke vnto thyne husband.

Eula. I am aquented with a certayne gentelman well lerned and a veri honest man, he married a yonge wyfe, a mayden of. xvii. yeare olde brede and brought vp of a chylde in the countre vnder her fathers and mother wing (as gentilmen delite to dwel in the countre) to hunt & hawke This yong gētilman would haue one that were unbrokē, because he might the soner breake her after hys owne mind, he begā to entre her in learning syngynge, and playinge, and by lytle and lytle to vse here to repete suche thynges as she harde at sermons, and to instruct her with other things that myght haue doone her more good in time to come. This gere, because it was straūge vnto this young womā which at home was brought vp in all ydelnesse, and with the light communication of her fathers seruantes, and other pastimes, begā to waxe greuouse & paynfull, vnto her. She withdrew her good mynde and dylygence and whē her husband called vpon her she put y^e finger in the eye, and wepte and many times she would fal downe on the grounde, beatynge her head agaynst the floure, as one that woulde be out of thys worlde. When there was no healpe for this gere, the good man as though he hadde bene wel asked his wyfe yf she woulde ryde into the countre with him a sporting vnto her fathers house, so that she graunted anone. When they were cōmē thyther, the gentelman left his wyfe with her mother & her sisters he wēt furth an huntynge with his father in lawe, there betwene theym two, he shewed al together, how that he hadde hoped to haue had a louynge companion to lead his lyfe withall, now he hath one that is alwaies blubberynge and pyninge her selfe awaye withoute anye remedie, he prayeth him to lay to hys hande in amendinge his doughters fautes her father

answered y^t he had ones giuen hym his doughter, and yf that she woulde not be rewled by wordes (a goddes name take Stafforde lawe) she was his owne. Then the gētylman sayd agayne, I know that I may do but I had leuer haue her amēded eyther by youre good counsell or commaundement, then to come vnto that extreme waies, her father promised that he would fynde a remedye. After a dai or two, he espied time and place whē he might be alone with his doughter. Then he loked sourely vpō his doughter, as though he had bene horne woode with her, he began to reherse how foule a beaste she was, how he feared many tymes that she neuer haue bestowed her. And yet sayde he much a doe, vnto my great coste and charg, I haue gottē the one that moughte lye by any Ladyes syde, and she were a quene and yet thou not perceiuyng what I haue done for the nor knowynge that thou hast suche a man whiche but of his goodnes myghte thynke thee to euill to be stoye in his kytchen, thou contrariest al his mind to make a short tale he spake so sharpely to her, that she feared that he wold haue beaten her. It is a man of asubtyll and wyllye wytte, whyche wythout a vysarde is ready to playe anye maner of parte. Thē this yonge wife what for feare, and for trouthe of the matter, cleane stryken oute of countenaunce, fell downe at her fathers fete desyryng hym that he wolde forgette and forgiue her all that was past and euer after she woulde doe her duetye Her father forgaue her, and promised that she shoulde finde him a kynd and a louynge father, yf so be that she perfourmed her promyse.

xantippa. How dyd she afterwarde?

Eulalya, whē she was departed frō her father she came backe into a chaumber, and there by chaunce found her husband alone she fel on her knees to hym and said. Mā in tymes paste, I neyther knewe you nor my selfe, from this daye froward ye shall se me cleane chaunged, onelye pardon that is past, with that her husbände toke her in his armes & kyssed her sayinge she should lacke nothyng yf she woulde holde her in that mind.

xantip. Why did she cōtinue so.

Eulalya. Euen tyll her endynge daye, nor there was none so vyle a thyng but that she woulde laye handes on it redely with all her herte, if her husband wolde let her, so great loue was begō and assured betwene them and many a daye after, shee thanked god y^t euer she met with such a mā. For yf she had not she sayd she had ben cleane caste awaye.

xan. We haue as greate plentie of suche housbandes, as of white crowes.

Eulalya. Now, but for werieng you? I coulde tell you a thyng that chaunced a late in this same citye.

xantypa. I haue litell to doe, and I lyke your communicacyon very well.

Eulalia. There was a certaine gentilmā he as suche sort of men do, vsed much huntyng in the cuntre, where he happened on a younge damoyzell, a very pore womā's child on whō he doted a man well stryken in age, and for her sake he lay oftē out of his owne house his excuse was hūtig. This mās wife an exceding honest womā, halfe deale suspecte the mater, tried out her husbandes falshed, on a tyme whē he had taken his iourney fourth of the town vnto some other waies, she wente vnto that poore cotage and boulded out all the hooles matter, where he laye on nights, wheron he drāke, what thyng thei had to welcō him withall. There was neither one thyng nor other, but bare walles. This good womā returned home, and sone after came againe brynginge w^t her a good soft bed, and al therto belongyng and certain plate besydes that she gaue them moneye, chargynge them that if the Gentilmā came agayne, they shold entreate him better not beyng knowē al this while that she was his wyfe, but fayued her to be her sister. Not long after her husband stale thether againe, he sawe the howse otherwyse decked, and better fare then he was wounte to haue. He asked, frome whence commeth al this goodly gere? They sayde that an honeste matrone, a kynsewoman of hys hadde broughte it thyther and commaunded thenm that he should be well cherished when so euer he came, by and by his hart gaue him that it was hys wiues dede, whan he came home he demaūded of her yf she hadde bene there or nay, she sayd yea. Then he asked her for what purpose she sente all that housholde stuffe thyther. Man (said she) ye haue bē tenderly brought vp. I perceiued that ye were but corslie handled there, me thought that it was my part, seing it was your wyll and pleasure to be there ye shoulde be better loked to.

Xantippa. She was one of goddes fooles. I woulde rather for a bed haue layd vnder him a bundel of nettels: or a burden of thistels.

Eula. But here the end her husbande perceyuyng the honeste of her great pacience neuer after laye from her, but made good cheare at home with his owne. I am sure ye knowe Gilberte the holāder.

Xan. Very well.

Eu. He (as it is not vnknowē married an old wife in his florishîg youth.

Xā. Per aduētūre he married the good and notthe woman.

Eulalia. There sayde ye well, setting lytell stoore by hys olde wife, hunted a callette, with whom he kept much companie abroad, he dined or supped litell at home. What wouldest thou haue sayd to y^e gere.

Xantip. What woulde I a said? I wolde haue flowē to the hores toppe and I wolde haue crowned myne husbāde at hys oute goinge to her with a pysbowle, that he so ēbawld might haue gon vnto his souerayne ladie.

Eula. But how much wiselier dyd this woman? She desyred that yonge woman home vnto her, and made her good chere, so by that meanes she brought home also her husband without any witchcraft or sorserie, and yf that at anye season he supped abroad with her she would sende vnto them some good dayntie morsel, and byd him make good chere

Xantippa. I had leuer be slayne then I woulde be bawde vnto myne owne husbāde.

Eulalia. Yea, but consyder all thynges well, was not that mucche better, then she shoulde be her shrewyshnesse, haue putte her husbādes minde cleane of from her, and so haue ledde all her life in trouble and heuynesse.

Xantippa. I graunte you well, that it was better so but I coulde not abyde it.

Eulalya. I wyll tell you a prety story more, and so make an ende One of oure neyghboures, a well disposed and a goddes man, but that he is some what testie, on a day pomeld his wife well and thriftely aboute the pate and so good a woman as euer was borne, she picked her into an inner parler, and there weepyng and sobbyng, eased her heuye harte, anone after, by chaunce her husbāde came into the same place, and founde hys wyfe wepyng. What sitest thou heare sayth he seighing & sobbîg like a child Thē she like a wise woman sayde. Is it not more honesty for me to lamente my dolours here in a secret place, thē to make wondering and on oute crye in the strete, as other womē do. At so wyfely and womanly a saing his hart melted, promysynge her faythfullye and truelie that he woulde neuer laye stroke on her afterwarde, nor neuer did.

Xantippa. No more wil mine god thanke my selfe.

Eulalya. But then ye are alwaies one at a nother, agreinge lyke dogges and cattes.

Xan. What wouldest thou that I should do?

Eu. Fyrst & formest, whatsoeuer thy husbande doeth sayde thou nothinge, for his harte must be wonne by lytell and litel by fayre meanes, gentillesse and forbearing at the last thou shalte eyther wynne him or at the least waie thou shalt leade a better life thē thou doest now.

Xantippa. He his beyonde goddes forbode, he wil neuer amende.

Eulalia. Eye saye not so, there is no beest so wild but by fayre handling be tamed, neuer mistrust man thē. Assay a moneth or two, blame me and thou findest not that my counsell dooeth ease. There be some fautes wyth you thoughe thou se them, be wyse of this especyall that thou neuer gyue hym foule wordes in the chambre, or inbed but be sure that all thynges there bee full of pastyme and pleasure. For yf that place which is ordeined to make amēdes for all fautes and so to renew loue, be polluted, eyther with strife or grugynges, then fayre wel al hope of loue daies, or atonementes, yet there be some beastes so wayward and mischeuous, that when theyr husbandes hath them in their arms a bed, they scholde & chyde making y^t same plesure their lewd condicions (that expelseth all displeasures oute of their husbandes mynde unpleasaunt and lytell set bi corrupting the medecine that shuld haue cured al deadly greifes, & odible offēces.

xantip. That is no newes to me.

Eula. Though the woman shulde be well ware and wyse that she shulde neuer be disobedient vnto her husbād yet she ought to be most circūspect that at meting she shew her selfe redy and pleasaunt unto him.

xantypa. Yea vnto a man, holde well withall but I am combred with a beast.

Eula. No more of those wordes, most commonly our husbādes ar euyl through our owne faute, but to returne againe vnto our taile they that ar sene in the olde fables of Poetes sai that Venus whome they make chiefe lady of wedlocke (hath a girdle made by the handy worke of Vulcan her Lorde, and in that is

thrust al that enforceth love and with that she girdeth her whan so ever she lyeth wyth her housbande

xantippa. A tale of a tubbe.

Eulalya. A tayle it is, but herkē what the taile meaneth.

xantippa. Tell me.

Eulalia That techeth us that the wyfe ought to dyspose her selfe all the she maye that lieng by her husbād she shew him al the plesure that she cā; Wherby the honest love of matrimony may reuiue and be renewed, & that there with be clene dispatched al grudges & malice

xant. But how shall we come by the thys gyrdle?

Eula. We nede neyther wytchraft nor enchauntment, ther is non of them al, so sure as honest condiciōs accompayned with good feloshyp.

xan. I can not fauoure suche an husbande as myne is.

Eula, It is moste thy profyt that he be no longer suche. If thou couldest by thy Circes craft chaunge thin husband into an hogge, or a bore wouldest thou do it?

xantip. God knoweth.

Eu. Art thou in dout? haddest thou leauer marye an hogge than a mā.

Xantip. Mary I had leauer haue a manne.

Eulalia. wel, what and thou coudest by sorcery make him of a drōkarde a soober man, of a vnthrifte a good housbande of an ydell losell a towarde body, woldest thou not doe it?

xantip. yes, hardely, woulde I doe it. But where shoulde I learne the cunnyng?

Eula. For soth that cōning hast thou in the if thou wouldest vtter it, thyn must he be, mauger thy head, the towarde y^e makest him, the better it is for the, thou lokest on nothing but on his leude cōdicions, and thei make the half mad, thou

wouldest amende hym and thou putttest hym farther oute of frame, loke rather on his good condicions, and so shalt thou make him better. It is to late calagayne yesterdaie before thou were maryed unto hym. It was tyme to cōsyder what his fautes were for a women shold not only take her husbände by the eyes but by the eares. Now it is more tyme to redresse fautes thē to fynd fautes.

xantt. What woman euer toke her gusband by the eares.

Eulali. She taketh her husbände by the eyes that loketh on nothyng, but on the beautye and pulcritude of the body. She taketh him by the eares, that harkeneth diligētly what the common voice sayth by him

xantip. Thy counsaile is good, but it commeth a day after the faire.

Eula. Yet it commeth time ynough to bringe thyne husbände to a greate furtheraunce to that shall bee yf God sende you anie frute together.

xantippa. We are spede alreedy of that.

Eulaly. How long ago.

Xantip. A good whyle ago

Eulalia. How many monethes old is it.

Xantip. It lacketh lytle of. vii.

Eula What a tale is this, ye reken the monethes by nightes and dayes double.

Xantippa. Not so.

Eula. It can not be none other wyse, yf ye reken from the mariage day.

xantippa. yea, but what thē, I spake with him before we were married.

Eulalia. Be children gotten by speakinge.

xantip. It befell so that he mette me alone and begon to ticke at me, and tickled me vnder the arme holes and sydes to make me laugh. I might not

awaie with ticklynge, but fell downe backwarde vpon a bedde and he a lofte, neuer leuinge kyssynge on me, what he did els I can not saye, but by sayncte Marie within a while after my bely beganne to swell.

Eula. Go now and disprayse thine husbāde whiche yf he gette children by playe, what wyll he do whē he goeth to it in good earnest.

xantippa, I fere me I am payed agayn.

Eula. Good locke God hath sent a fruitfull grounde, a good tylmā.

Xantip. In that thing he might haue lesse laboure and more thanke.

Eula. Few wyues finde at theyr husbandes in that behalfe but were ye thē sure together.

xanti. yea that we were

Eula. The offence is the lesse. Is it a man chylde.

xantip. yea.

Eula. He shal make you at one so that ye wil bow & forbere. What saieth other mē by thin husband, they that be his cōpanions, they delite with him abroad

xā, They say that he is meruelous gentyl, redy to do euery man pleasure, liberal and sure to his frende.

Eula. And that putteth me in good cōfort that he wyll be ruled after our counsayll.

xantip. But I fynde him not so.

Eula. Order thy selfe to him as I haue tolde thee, and cal me no more true sayer but a lier, if he be not so good vnto the as to anie creature liuinge Again cōsidre this he is yet but a childe, I thinke he passethe not. xxiiij. the blacke oxe neuer trode on hys fote, nowe it is but loste laboure to reckon vpon anye deuorse.

xantippa. Yet manye a tyme and ofte I haue troubled my braynes withal

Eulalia. As for that fantasye whensoever it commeth into your mynd first of all counte how naked a thyng woman is, deuorsed from man. It is the hyghest dignitie that longethe to the wyfe to obsequyous vnto her spouse. So hath natyre ordeined so god hath appoynted, that the woman shoulde be ruled al by the man loke onely vppon this whiche is trouthe, thine husbāde he is, other canste thou none haue. Againe forgette not that swete babe be gotten of both your bodies what thin beste thou to do with that, wylte thou take it awaye with thee? Thou shalte bereue thyne husband his ryght wylt thou leue it with hym? thou shalt spoile thy self of thy chiefe Jewell thou haste. Beside all this tell me trueth hast thou none euyl wyllers, Besyde all thys tell me trueth, hast thou none euyl wyllers.

xan. I haue a stepdame I warrant you, and myne husbādes mother euen such another.

Eula. Do they hate the so deadly.

xantip. They woulde se me hanged.

Eula. Thē forget not thē what greater plesure couldest thou shew them then to se the deuorsed from thine husband and to led a wydowes lyfe. Yea and worse thē a wydow, for wydowes be at their choise.

xantippa. I holde well with youre cōsell, but I can not awaye with the paynes.

Eulalia. yet reckon what paines ye toke or ye colde teache your paret to speake.

xantippa. Exceedynge much.

Eu. And thinke you much to labour a lytel in reforming your husbād with whō you may liue merely all the dayes of your lyfe. What busines doe mē put thē self to be wel & easly horsed & shal we think our selues to good to take paines that we mai haue our husbādes gētil & curteise vnto vs.

xantip. What shal I do.

Eu. I haue told you al redy, se that al thing be clene & trim at home, that no sluttish or vnclenlye syghtes dryue hym oute a dores. Be your selfe alwayes

redy at a becke, berynge continuall in minde what reuerēce the wife oweth vnto her husbād. Be neyther in your dūpes, nor alwayes on your mery pinnes go nether to homely nor to nycely. Let your meat be cleane dressed, you know yourhusbādes diet. What he loueth best that dresse. Moreouer shewe your selfe louinge and fayre spokē vnto thē where he loueth, call them now and thē vnto your table. At meate, se that al thinges be well sauored, and make good there, And whē that he is toppe heuy playing on his lute, sytte thou by and singe to him so shalte thou make hym keepe home, and lessen hys expences This shall he thynke at length, in faythe I am a fonde felowe that maketh suche chere with a strumpet abroode with greate lossee bothe of substance and name, seyng that I haue a wyfe at home bothe muche fayrer, and one that loueth me ten times better, with whome I may be both clenlyer receiued and dayntelier cherished

xantip. Beleuest thou that it will take and I put it into a profe.

Eulali. Looke on me. I warrante it or ought longe I wyll in hande with thyne husbande, & I will tell hym his part.

xantippa. ye marie that is well sayde. But be wyse that he espie not our casle, he would plaie his fages, all the house should be to lytle for hym.

Eulalia. Take no thoughte. I shall so conuey my matters, that he shall dysclose all together hym selfe, what busynesse is betwene you, that done I wyll handell him pretelie as I thinke beste, and I truste to make him a new man for the and when I se my time I wyl make a lie for thee, how louinge thou hast spoken of him.

xantippa. Chryst spede vs and bringe our pupose well aboute.

Eulalia. He will not fayle the so thou do thy good wyll.

There was a man that married a woman whiche hadde great riches and beawtye. Howe bee it she hadde suche an impedymēt of nature that she was domme and coulde not speake, whiche thyng made him ryghte pensyfe, and sayd, wherfore vpon a daye as he walked alone ryght heuye in hearte thynkyng vpon his wyfe. There came one to hym and asked him what was the cause of his heuyesse whiche answered that it was onely bycause his wife was borne

dōme. To whome this other said I shal shewe the soone a remedy and a medycyne (therfore that is thus) go tak an aspen leafe and lay it vnder her tōge this night shee beinge a sleape, and I warrant the that shee shall speake on the morowe whiche man beyng glad of thys medycyne prepared therfore and gathered aspen leaues, wherfore he layd thre of them vnder her tonge whan shee was a sleape. And on the morow when he him selfe awaked he Desyrous to know how hys medicine wrought being in bed with her, he demaunded of her how she did, and sodēly she answered and sayd, I beshrewe thy harte for waking me so early, and so by the vertue of that medycyne she was restored to her speche. But in cōclusion her spech encresed day by day and she was so curst of cōdycyon that euery daie she brauled and chyd with her husbände, so mucche at the laste he was more weped, and had much more trouble and disease wyth her shrewed wordes then he hadde before whē she was dumme, wherfore as he walked another time alone he happened to mete agayne with the same personne that taught hym the sayde medycine and sayde to hym thys wyse. Syr ye taught me a medicin but late to make my domme wyfe to speake, byddyng me lay an aspen leafe vnder her toūg when she sleapte, and I layde three Aspen leaves there. Wherfore nowe she speaketh. But yet she speaketh soo much & so shrewdlye that I am more werier of her now, then I was when she was dōme: Wherfore I praie you teache me a medycine to modyfye her that she speake not so mucche. This other answered and sayd thus. Sir I am a deuyl of hel but I am one of thē that haue least power there. Al be yet I haue power to make a womā to speake, but and yf a woman begin ones to speake, I nor al the deuyls in hel that haue the mooste power be not able to make a woman to be styll, nor to cause her to leue speakyng.

The end of this pleasant dialogue declaryng the seuerall properties of y^e two contrary disposers of the wyues aforesayde.

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church yearde, at the sygne of
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✠ A mery Dia-
logue, declaringe the proper-
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D. Erasmus
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mus.
Translated into
Englyshe.
✠*✠
2

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Anno. M.CCCCC.
LVII.

[Return to the first section without the original page images](#)


Eulalia. God spede, & a thou
 sand mine old acquaintance.
 xantippa.xan. As many a-
 gayn, my dere hert. Eula!f.
 me semets ye ar warē much faire now
 of late. Eula. Saye you so? gyue you
 me a mocke at the first dash.xan. Nay
 veryly but I take you so. Eula. Hap-
 pely mi new gown maketh me to loke
 fayrer then I wolde doe. xan. Sothe
 you saye, I haue not sene a mynioner
 this many dayes, I reken it Englishe
 cloth. Eu. It is english stuff and dyed
 in Venis. xan. It is softer then sylke
 what an oriente purpel coloze here is
 who gaue you so rich a gift. Eu. How
 wolde honeste women come by their
 gere? but by their husbandes. xā. Hap-
 py arte thou that hathe suche an hus-
 band, but I wolde to god for his pas-
 syon, that I had maryed an husband
 of clowes, when I had married col my
 good mā. Eula. Why say ye so. I pray
 you. are you at oddes now. xā. I shal
 neuer be at one wth him ye se how beg-
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Eula. Why say ye so. I
pray you, are you at
oddes now.

gerly I go. I haue not an hole smock
 to put on my backe, and he is wel con-
 tente with all: I praye god I neuer
 come in heuen & I be not ashamed of-
 times to shewe my head, when I se o-
 ther wiues how net and trim they go
 that ar marched with farre porer mē
 then he is. **Eula.** The apparell of ho-
 nest wiues is not in the aray of the bo-
 dy, nor in the tirementes of their head
 as saynte Peter the apostle teacheth
 vs (and that I learned a late at a ser-
 mon) but in good lyuyng and honest
 conuersacion and in the oznamentes
 of the soule, the cōmon buenes ar pain-
 ted vp, to please manye mennes eies
 we ar trime ynough yf we please our
 husbands only. **xan.** But yet my good
 man so euyl wylling to bestow oughe
 vpon his wyfe, maketh good chere,
 and lssheth out the dowrye that hee
 hadde with mee no small pot of wine.
Eulaly. where vpon: cantipha, where-
 on hym lykethe beste, at the tauerne,
 at the steeves, and at the dyce. **Eulalia**
 Peace

xā. I shal neuer be at
 one w^t him ye se how
 beggerly I go. I haue not
 an hole smock to put on
 my backe, and he is wel
 contente with all: I
 praye god I neuer come
 in heuen & I be not
 ashamed oftymes to
 shewe my head, when I
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 and trim they go that ar
 matched with farre
 porer mē then he is.

Eula. The apparell of
 honest wiues is not in
 the aray of the body, nor
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Eulaly, where vpon?

xantipha, wheron hym
lykethe beste, at the
tauerne, at the stewes
and at the dyce.

Peace saye not so. xan. wel yet thus it is, then when he cometh home to me at midnight, longe watched for, he lyeth rowtyng lyke a sloyne all the leue longe nyght, yea and now and the he all bespeweth his bed, and worse then I will say at this tyme. Eulali. Peace thou dyshonesteth thy self, when thou doest dishonesteth thy husbād. xantip. The deuyl take me bodye and bones but I had leuer lye by a sow with pigges, then with suche a bedfelowe. Eulali. Doest thou not then take him vp, wel fauoredly for stūbling. xantip. As he deserueth I spare no tonge. Eulali. a. what doth he the. xantip. At the first breake he toke me vp vengeably, trusting that he shoulde haue shakē me of and put me to scilence with his crabid wordes. Eula Came neuer your hote wordes vnto hād strokes. xantip. On a tyme we fel so farre at wordes þ we wer almost by þ eares togither. Eula what say you womā. xan. He toke vp a staffe wandryng at me, as the deuill hadde

Eulalia Peace saye not so.

xan. wel yet thus it is, then when he cometh home to me at midnight, longe watched for, he lyeth rowtyng lyke a sloyne all the leue longe nyght, yea and now and the he all bespeweth his bed, and worse then I will say at this tyme.

Eulali. Peace thou dyshonesteth thy self, when thou doest dishonesteth thy husbād.

xantip. The deuyl take me bodye and bones but I had leuer lye by a sow with pigges, then with suche a bedfelowe.

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Xantip. As he deserueth I spare no tonge.

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together.

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xan. He toke vp a staffe
wandryng at me, as the
deuill had bene on hym
ready to laye me on the
bones.

had bene on hym ready to laye me on
 the bones. Eula. were thou not redye
 to ron in at the bēch hole. xanti. Nay
 mary I warrant the. I gat me a thre
 foted stole in hand, & he had but ones
 layd his littell finger on me, he shulde
 not haue founde me lame. I woulde
 haue holden his nose to the grindstōe
 Eulalia. A newe found shelde, ye wan-
 ted but youre dystaffe to haue made
 you a speare. xantip. And he shoulde
 not greatlye a laughed at his parte.
 Eulali. Ah my frynde. xantypa. that
 way is neither good nor godly, xantip
 pa what is neither good nor godly. yf
 he wyll not vse me, as hys wyfe: I wil
 not take him for my husbände. Eula-
 lya. But Paule sayeth that wyues
 shoulde bee boner and buxome vnto
 their husbādes with all humylytye,
 and Peter also bryngethe vs an ex-
 ample of Sara, that called her hus-
 bāde Abrahame, Lorde. xantippa. I
 know that as well as you the y same
 paule say that men shoulde loue theyr
 wyues

Eula. were thou not redye
 to ron in at the bēch hole.

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 the. I gat me a thre foted
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 bryngethe vs an example
 of Sara, that called her

husbande Abrahame,
Lorde.

wyues, as Christ loued his spouse the
 churche let him do his duete I wil do
 myne. Eula. But for all that, when the
 matter is so farre that the one muste
 forber the other it is reason that the
 woman giue place vnto the man, xan.
 Is he meete to be called my husbāde
 that maketh me his vnderlynge and
 his dryuel. Eula. But tel me dame xā
 tip. Would he neuer offre the stripes
 after that xātip. Not a stripe, and ther
 in he was the wyser man for & he had
 he should haue repented euery vayne
 in hys harte. Eulali. But thou offered
 him foule wordes plentie, xantip. And
 will do. Eula. What doth he y^e meane
 seasō. xantip. What doth he sometye
 he cowcheth an hogeshed, somtyme he
 doth nothing but stande and laughe
 at me, other whyle taketh hys Lute
 wheron is scarllie thre strynges lay-
 enge on that as fast as he may dryue
 because he would not here me. Eula.
 Doeth that greue thee. xantippa. To
 beyende home, man; a tyme I haue
 I it much

xantippa. I know that as
 well as you thē y^e same
 paule say that men shoulde
 loue theyr wyues, as Christ
 loues his spouse the
 churche let him do his
 duete I wil do myne.

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 meane seasō.

xantip. What doth he
sometyme cowcheth an
hogeshed, sometime he doth
nothing but stande and
laughe at me, other whyle
takethe hys Lute wheron is
scarslie three strynges
layenge on that as fast as he
may dryue because he
would not here me.

Eula. Doeth that greue
thee?

xantippa. To beyonde
home, manie a tyme I haue
much a do to hold my
handes.

much a do to hold my handes. Eula,
 Neighbour. xantip. wylt thou gyue
 me leaue to be playn with the. xantip-
 pa Good leaue haue you. Eula. Be as
 bolde on me agayne our olde acqnayn
 taunce and amite, euen frō our chylde-
 hode, would it should be so. xantippa.
 Trueth you saie, there was neuer wo-
 man kinde that I fauoured more Ela-
 ly Whatsoeuer thy husbād be, marke
 well this, chaunge thou canst not, In
 the olde lawe, where the deuill hadde
 cast aboone betwene the man and the
 wife, at the worste waye they myght
 be deuorsed, but now that remedie is
 past, euē till death depart you he must
 nedes be thy husbāde, and thou hys
 wyfe, xan. Il mote they thryue & thei
 that taken away that liberty from vs
 Eulalia. Beware what thou sayest, it
 was christes act. Xā. I can euil beleue
 that Eula. It is none other wyse, now
 it is beste that eyther of you one be-
 yng with an other, ye labour to liue
 at reste and peace. xantypa, Why-
 can

Eula. Neighbour. xantip.
 wylt thou gyue me leaue to
 be playn with the.

xantippa Good leaue haue
 you.

Eula. Be as bolde on me
 agayne our olde
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 euen frō our chylde-
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Eulalia. Beware what thou
 sayest, it was christes act.

Xā. I can euil beleue that

Eula. It is none otherwyse,
now it is beste that eyther
of you one beyng with an
other, ye laboure to liue at
reste and peace.

can I forgeue him a new. Eu. It lieth
 great parte in the womē, for the orde-
 ringe of theyr husbandes. xan. Lea-
 dest thou a mery life with thine. Eula
 Now all is well. xan. Ergo ther was
 somewhat to do at your fyrste metyng
 Eula. Neuer no greate busynes, but
 yet as it, happeneth now and than be-
 twene man & womā, there was foule
 cloudes a loft, that might haue made
 a stozme but that they were ouer blo-
 wen with good humanitie and wyse
 handlynge. Euery man hath hys ma-
 ner and euery mā hath his seuerall ap-
 tite or mynde, and thinkes hys owne
 way best, & yf we list not to lie there li-
 ueth no mā without faulte, which yf a-
 nie were elles, ywis in wedlocke they
 ought to know and not vtterly hated
 xan, you say well, Eulalya. It happe-
 neth many times that loue dayes bre-
 keth betwene man and wife, befoze ſ
 one be perfittly knowē vnto the other
 beware of that in any wise, for when
 malice is ones begon, loue is but ba-
 rren

xantypa. Why? can I
 forgeue him a new,

Eu. It lieth great parte in
 the womē, for the
 orderinge of theyr
 husbandes.

xan. Leadeest thou a mery
 life with thine.

Eula Now all is well.

xan. Ergo ther was
 somewhat to do at your
 fyrste metying

Eula. Neuer no greate
 busynes, but yet as it,
 happeneth now and than
 betwene man & womā,
 there was foule cloudes a
 loft, that might haue made
 a stozme but that they were
 ouer blowen with good
 humanitie and wyse
 handlynge. Euery man
 hath hys maner and euery
 mā hath his seuerall aptite
 or mynde, and thinkes hys
 owne way best, & yf we
 list not to lie there liueth
 no mā without faulte,
 which yf anie were elles,
 ywis in wedlocke they
 ought to know and not
 vtterly hated

xan, you say well,

Eulalya. It happeneth
many times that loue
dayes breketh betwene
man and wife, before y^e
one be perfitly knowē vnto
the other beware of that in
any wife, for when malice
is ones begon, loue is but
barely redressed agayne,

rely redressed agayne, namelpe, yf the
 mater grow furthe vnto bytter chec-
 kes, & shamfull raylinges such things
 as are fastened with glew, yf a manne
 wyll all to shake them strayght waye
 whyle the glew is warme, they soone
 fal in peces, but after þ^e glew is ones
 dried by they cleue together so fast as
 anie thing, wherfore at the beginning
 a meanes must be made, that loue mai
 encrease and be made sure betwene þ^e
 man & the wife, & that is best brought
 aboute by gentilnesse and fayre condy-
 cions, for the loue that beautie onelie
 causeth, is in a maner but a cheri faire
 Xan. But I praye you hartelye tell
 me, by what pollycy ye brought your
 good man to folow your daunce. Eula.
 I wyll tell you on this condicyon,
 that ye will folowe me. Xan. I can. Eula.
 It is as easy as water yf ye cā find
 in your hart to do it, noz yet no good
 time past for he is a yong mā, and you
 ar but agirle of age, and I trowe it is
 not a pere ful sins ye wer married. Xā.
 All

namely, yf the mater grow
 furthe unto bytter
 checkes, & shamfull
 raylinges such things as
 are fastened with glew, yf
 a manne wyll all to shake
 them strayght waye whyle
 the glew is warme, they
 soone fal in peces, but
 after y^e glew is ones dried
 vp they cleue together so
 fast as anie thing,
 wherefore at the
 beginning a meanes must
 be made, that loue mai
 encrease and be made
 sure betwene y^e man &
 the wife, & that is best
 brought aboute by
 gentilnesse and fayre
 condicions, for the loue
 that beautie onelie
 causeth, is in a maner but
 a cheri faire.

Xan. But I praye you
 hartelye tell me, by what
 pollycy ye brought your
 good man to folow your
 daunce.

Eula. I wyll tell you on
 this condicyon, that ye
 will folowe me.

xan. I can.

Eula, It is as easy as
water if ye cā find in your
hart to do it, nor yet no
good time past for he is a
yong mā, and you ar but
agirle of age, and I trowe
it is not a yere ful sins ye
wer married.

All thys is true Eulalia. I wyll shew
you then. But you must kepe it secret
xantip. with a ryght good wyl. Eula.
This was my chyefe care, to kepe me
alwayes in my housbandes fauoure,
that there shulde nothyng angre him
I obserued his appetite and pleasure
I marked the tymes bothe whan he
woulde be pleased and when he wold
be all byshrwed, as they tameth the
Elephantes and Lyons or suche beas-
tes that can not be wonne by strēgh
xantypa. Suche a beaste haue I at
home. Eula. Thei that goth vnto the
Elephantes weare no white garmen-
tes, nor they that tame wylde bulles,
weare no blasyng reedes, for experi-
ence teacheth, that suche beastes bee
madde with those colours, like as the
Tyggers by the sounde of tumbrels be
made so wode, that thei plucke theym
self in peces. Also thei þ breake horses
haue their termes and theyr soundes
theyr hadlynges, and other knackes
to breake their wylidnes, wyth all.

How

Xā All thys is true

Eulalia. I wyll shew you then. But you must kepe it secret

xantip. with a ryght good wyl.

Eula. This was my chyefe care, to kepe me alwayes in my housbandes fauoure, that there shulde nothyng angre him I obserued his appetite and pleasure I marked the tymes bothe whan he woulde be pleased and when he wold be all byshrwed, as they tameth the Elephantes and Lyons or suche beastes that can not be wonne by strēgh

xantypa. Suche a beaste haue I at home.

Eula. Thei that goth vnto the Elephantes weare no white garmentes, nor they that tame wylde bulles, weare no blasyng reedes, for experience teacheth, that suche beastes bee madde with those colours, like as the Tyggers by the sounde of tumbrels be made so wode, that thei plucke

theymselſ in peces. Also
thei y^t breake horses haue
their termes and theyr
soundes theyr hadlynges,
and other knackes to
breake their wyldnes, wyth
all.

Howe much more then is it oure due-
 tyes that ye wyues to vse suche cra-
 ftes toward our husbandes with whō
 all our lyfe tyme wil we, nyl we is one
 house, and one bed. xantip. furthwith
 your tale. Eula, whē I had ones mar-
 ked there thynges. I applted my selfe
 bnto hym, well ware not to displease
 hym. xantip. How could thou do that.
 Eulalya. Fyrste in the ouerseyng my
 householde, which is the very charge
 and cure of wyues, I wayted euer,
 not onely gyuyng hede that nothing
 shoulde be forgotten or vndoone, but
 that althynges shoulde as he woulde
 haue it, wer it euer so small a trifle. xā
 wherin. Eulalia. As thus. Yf mi good
 man had a fantasye to this thyng, or
 to that thyng, or if he woulde haue his
 meate dresed on this fashon, or that
 fashon. xan. But how couldest thou
 fassyon thye selfe after hys wyll and
 mynde, that eyther woulde not be at
 home, or elles be as fesshe as a saulte
 berryng. Elali. Abyde a while. I come
 not

Howe much more then is
 it oure dueties that y^e
 wyues to use suche
 craftes toward our
 husbandes with whō all
 our lyfe tyme wil we, nyl
 we is one house, and one
 bed.

xantip. furthwith your
 tale.

Eula, whē I had ones
 marked there thynges. I
 applied my selfe unto
 hym, well ware not to
 displease him.

xantip. How could thou
 do that.

Eulalya. Fyrste in the
 ouerseyng my
 householde, which is the
 very charge and cure of
 wyues, I wayted euer, not
 onely gyuyng hede that
 nothing shoulde be
 forgotten or undoone, but
 that althynges should be
 as he woulde haue it, wer
 it euer so small a trifle.

xā. wherin.

Eulalia. As thus. Yf mi
 good man had a fantasye
 to this thyng, or to that

thyng, or if he would
haue his meate dressed
on this fashion, or that
fashion.

xan. But howe couldest
thou fashyon thye selfe
after hys wyll and
mynde, that eyther
woulde not be at home or
elles be as freshe as a
saulte heryng.

not at that yet, yf my husband wer be
 ey sad at anye tyme, no time to speake
 to him. I laughed not nor tryfled him
 as many a woman doth but I looked
 eufully and heauyly, for as a glasse (if
 it be a true stone) representeth euer y^e
 physnamp of hym that loketh in it, so
 lyke wyse it becommeth a wedded wo
 man alway to agre vnto the appetite
 of her husbände, that she be not mery
 whē he murneth, nor dysposed to play
 whē he is sad. And if that at any time
 he be waiward shrewshaken, either I
 pacyfye hym with faire wordes, or I
 let hym alone, vntyll the wynde be o
 uerblowen gyuing him neuer a word
 at al, vntyll the time come that I may
 eyther excuse my faute, or tell hym of
 hys. In lyke wyse when he commeth
 home wel whitled, I gyue hym gen
 tyll and fayre woordes, so with fayre
 entreatynge I gette hym to bed. *can
 typpa*, O carefull state of wyues, whē
 they muste be gladd and fayne to fol
 lowe their husbandes mindes, be they
 cluyse

Elali. Abyde a while. I
 come not at that yet, yf
 my husband wer very sad
 at anye tyme, no time to
 speake to him. I laughed
 not nor tryfled him as
 many a woman doth but I
 looked rufully and
 heauyly, for as a glasse (if
 it be a true stone)
 representeth euer y^e
 physnamy of hym that
 loketh in it, so lyke wyse it
 becommeth a wedded
 woman alway to agre vnto
 the appetite of her
 husbände, that she be not
 mery whē he murneth, nor
 dysposed to play whē he
 is sad. And if that at any
 time he be waiward
 shrewshaken, either I
 pacyfye hym with faire
 wordes, or I let hym
 alone, vntyll the wynd be
 ouerblowen gyuing him
 neuer a word at al, vntill
 the time come that I may
 eyther excuse my faute, or
 tell hym of hys. In lyke
 wyse when he commeth
 home wel whitled, I gyue
 hym gentyll and fayre
 woordes, so with fayre
 entreatynge I gette hym to
 bed.

xantypa, O careful state
of wyues, whē they muste
be gladde and fayne to
followe their husbandes
mindes, be thei eluyshe,
dronken, or doying what
myschiefe they liste.

elup she. Drunken, or doyng what myt
 chiese they like. Eula. As whoe saith
 this gentill Dealyngge serueth not for
 bothe partyes, for they spyte of theyr
 berdes muste suffre many thynges in
 our demeanoz, yet a time ther is, whē
 in a weighty matter it is lafull that
 the wyfe tell the good mā his faute, if
 that it be matter of substaunce, for at
 lyght trifles, it is best to play byll vn-
 der wyngge. xantyp. what tune is that
 Eula. when he is ydle, neither angry,
 pensife, nor ouerslen, then betwixt you
 two secretly he must be told his faute
 gētly, or rather intreated, that in this
 thyngge or that he play the better hus-
 bande, to loke better to his good na-
 me and fame and to his helth and this
 tellyng must be myxt with mery con-
 ceites and pleasaunt woordes many ti-
 mes I make a meane to tel my tale af-
 ter this fashyon, that he shall promise
 me, hee shall take no displeasure wyth
 my thyngge, that I a foolyshe woman
 shall breake vnto hym, that pertay-
 neth

Eula. As whoe saith this
 gentill dealyngge serueth
 not for bothe partyes, for
 they spyte of theyr berdes
 muste suffre many thynges
 in our demeanor, yet a time
 ther is, whē in a weighty
 matter it is lafull that the
 wyfe tell the good mā his
 faute, if that it be matter of
 substaunce, for at lyght
 trifles, it is best to play byll
 under wyngge.

xantyp. what tune is that

Eula. when he is ydle,
 neither angry, pensife, nor
 ouerslen, then betwixt you
 two secretly he must be
 told his faute gētly, or
 rather intreated, that in this
 thyngge or that he play the
 better husbände to loke
 better to his good name
 and fame and to his helth
 and this tellyng must be
 myxt with mery conceites
 and pleasaunt wordes
 many times I make a
 meane to tel my tale after
 this fashyon, that he shall
 promise me, he shall take
 no displeasure wyth my
 thyngge, that I a foolyshe
 woman shall breake vnto
 hym, that pertayneth

eyther to hys helthe
worshyppe or welth.

neth erther to hys helthe woꝝ chyppe
 oꝝ welth. When I haue sayde that I
 woulde, I chop cleane from that com-
 munication and falle into some other
 pastime, for this is all oure fautes,
 neyghbour Xantippa, that whē we be-
 gyn ones to chat our tounes neuer
 lie. Xantip. So men say Eulalia.
 Thus was I well ware on, that I ne-
 uer tell my husbād his fautes befoze
 companie, nor I neuer caried any cō-
 playnte furthe a dozes: the mendes is
 soner made whē none knoweth it but
 two, and there were anie suche faute
 that myght not be wel bozne nor amē-
 ded by þ wyues tellige, it is moze lau-
 dable that the wiffe make complaynte
 vnto the Parentes and kynnsfolke of
 her husband, then vnto her own, and
 so to moderate her complaynte that
 she seme not to hate hym but hys vice
 nor let her play all the blabbe, that in
 some poynt vnuttered, he may know &
 loue his wiues curteysy. Xantip. She
 had nede be as wel lerned womā, that
 Would

When I haue sayde that I
 woulde, I chop cleane
 from that communication
 and falle into some other
 pastime, for this is all our
 fautes, neyghbour
 Xantippa, that whē we
 begyn ones to chat our
 tounes neuer lie.

Xantip. So men say

Eulalia. Thus was I well
 ware on, that I neuer tell
 my husbād his fautes
 before companie, nor I
 neuer caried any cōplaynte
 furthe a dozes: the mendes
 is soner made whē none
 knoweth it but two, and
 there were anie suche faute
 that myght not be wel
 borne nor amēded by y^e
 wyues tellige, it is more
 laudable that the wife
 make complaynte vnto the
 Parentes and kynnsfolke of
 her husband, then vnto her
 own, and so to moderate
 her complaynte that she
 seme not to hate hym but
 hys vice nor let her play
 all the blabbe, that in some
 poynt vnuttered, he may
 know & loue his wiues
 curteysy.

Xantip. She had nede be
aswellerned womā, that
would do all this.

Would do all this. **Eu.** Mary through
 suche demeanoure, we shall sterre our
 husbādes vnto lyke gentylnesse. **Xan:**
 There be some that cannot be amen-
 ded with all the gentyll handlyng in
 the worlde. **Eula.** In faith I thyncke
 nay, but case there be, marke this wel
 the good man must be for borne, howe
 soeuer the game goeth, then is it bet-
 ter to haue him alwayes at one point
 or els more kinde and louing throw
 oure gentill handlyng, then to haue
 him worse and worse throwe our cur-
 sednesse, what wyll you say and I tell
 you of husbādes that hath won theyr
 wiues by suche curtesie, howe muche
 more are we boūde to vse the same to-
 warde our husbādes. **Xantip.** Than
 shall you tell of one farre vnlyke vnto
 thyne husband. **Eula.** I am aquented
 with a certayne gentelman well ler-
 ned and a veri honest man, he married
 a yonge wyfe, a mayden of. xlii. yere
 olde bryde and brought vp of a chyld
 in the countre vnder her fathers and
 mothers

Eu. Mary through suche
 demeanoure, we shall
 sterre our husbādes vnto
 lyke gentylnesse.

Xan: There be some that
 cannot be amended with
 all the gentyll handlyng
 in the worlde.

Eula: In faith I thyncke
 nay, but case there be,
 marke this wel the good
 man must be for borne,
 howe soeuer the game
 goeth, then is it better to
 haue him alwayes at one
 point or els more kinde
 and louing throw oure
 gentill handlyng, then to
 haue him worse and worse
 throwe our cursednesse,
 what wyll you say and I
 tell you of husbādes that
 hath won theyr wiues by
 suche curtesie, howe
 muche more are we boūde
 to use the same towarde
 our husbādes.

Xantip. Than shall you
 tell of one farre vnlyke
 vnto thyne husband.

Eula. I am aquented with
 a certayne gentelman well
 lerned and a veri honest
 man, he married a yonge

wyfe, a mayden of. xvii.
yeare olde brede and
brought vp of a chylde in
the countre vnder her
fathers and mother wing

mother being (as gentilmen delite to
 dwel in the countre) to hunt & hawke
 This yong gētilman would haue one
 that were unbroke, because he might
 the soner breake her after hys owne
 mind, he begā to entre her in learning
 syngynge, and playinge, and by lytle
 and lytle to vse here to repete suche
 thynges as she harde at sermons, and
 to instruct her with other things that
 myght haue doone her more good in
 time to come. This gere, because it
 was straūge vnto this young womā
 which at home was brought vp in all
 ydelnesse, and with the light commu-
 nication of her fathers seruantes,
 and other pastimes, begā to waxe gre-
 uouse & paynfull, vnto her. She with-
 drew her good mynde and dylygence
 and whē her husband called vpon her
 she put y^e finger in the eye, and wepte
 and many times she would fal downe
 on the grounde, beatynge her head a-
 gaynst the floure, as one that would
 be out of thys worlde. When there
 was

(as gentilmen delite to
 dwel in the countre) to
 hunt & hawke This yong
 gētilman would haue one
 that were unbroke, because
 he might the soner breake
 her after hys owne mind,
 he begā to entre her in
 learning syngynge, and
 playinge, and by lytle and
 lytle to vse here to repete
 suche thynges as she harde
 at sermons, and to instruct
 her with other things that
 myght haue doone her
 more good in time to
 come. This gere, because it
 was straūge vnto this
 young womā which at
 home was brought vp in all
 ydelnesse, and with the
 light communication of her
 fathers seruantes, and
 other pastimes, begā to
 waxe greuouse & paynfull,
 vnto her. She withdrew her
 good mynde and
 dylygence and whē her
 husband called vpon her
 she put y^e finger in the
 eye, and wepte and many
 times she would fal downe
 on the grounde, beatynge
 her head agaynst the
 floure, as one that would
 be out of thys worlde.

was no healpe for this gere, the good
man as though he hadde bene wel as-
ked his wyfe yf she woulde ryde into
the countre with him a sportyng vnto
her fathers house, so that she graun-
ted anone. When they were comē thy-
ther, the gentilman left his wyfe with
her mother & her sisters he wēt furth
an huntynge with his father in lawe,
there betwene theym two, he shewed
al together, how that he hadde hoped
to haue had a lounge companion to
lead his lyfe withall, now he hath one
that is alwaies blubberyng and py-
nyng her selfe awaye withoute anye
remedie, he prayeth him to lay to hys
hande in amendinge his daughters
fautes her father answered & he had
ones giuen hym his daughter, and yf
that she woulde not be rewled by wo-
des (a goddes name take Stafforde
lawe) she was his owne. Then the ge-
tylman sayd agayne, I knowe that I
may do but I had leuer haue her amē-
ded eyther by youre good counsell or
commaund

When there was no healpe
for this gere, the good man
as though he hadde bene
wel asked his wyfe yf she
woulde ryde into the
countre with him a
sportyng vnto her fathers
house, so that she graunted
anone. When they were
comē thyther, the
gentilman left his wyfe
with her mother & her
sisters he wēt furth an
huntynge with his father in
lawe, there betwene theym
two, he shewed al together,
how that he hadde hoped
to haue had a lounge
companion to lead his lyfe
withall, now he hath one
that is alwaies blubberyng
and pyning her selfe
awaye withoute anye
remedie, he prayeth him to
lay to hys hande in
amendinge his daughters
fautes her father answered
y^t he had ones giuen hym
his daughter, and yf that
she woulde not be rewled
by wordes (a goddes name
take Stafforde lawe) she
was his owne. Then the
gētylman sayd agayne, I
know that I may do but I
had leuer haue her amēded
eyther by youre good

counsell or
commaundement,

comfaunderment, then to come vnto
 that extreme waies, her father promi-
 sed that he woulde fynde a remedye.
 After a dai or two, he espied time and
 place whē he might be alone with his
 doughter. Then he loked soureli vpō
 his doughter, as though he had bene
 horne woode with her, he began to re-
 herse how foule a beaste she was, how
 he feared many tymes that she neuer
 haue bestowed her. And yet sayde he
 muche a doe, vnto my great coste and
 charg, I haue gottē the one that moug-
 hte lye by any Ladyes syde, and she
 were a quene and yet thou not per-
 ceuynge what I haue done for the nor
 knowynge that thou hast suche a man
 whiche but of his goodnes myghte
 thynke thee to euill to be stoye in his
 kytchen, thou contrariest al his mind
 to make a short tale he spake so sharpe-
 ly to her, that she feared that he wold
 haue beaten her. It is a man of asub-
 tyll and wylle wytt, whyche wyth-
 out a vysarde is ready to playe anye
 maner

then to come vnto that
 extreme waies, her father
 promised that he would
 fynde a remedye. After a
 dai or two, he espied time
 and place whē he might be
 alone with his doughter.
 Then he loked soureli vpō
 his doughter, as though he
 had bene horne woode
 with her, he began to re-
 herse how foule a beaste
 she was, how he feared
 many tymes that she neuer
 haue bestowed her. And
 yet sayde he much a doe,
 vnto my great coste and
 charg, I haue gottē the one
 that moughe lye by any
 Ladyes syde, and she were
 a quene and yet thou not
 perceiuyng what I haue
 done for the nor knowynge
 that thou hast suche a man
 whiche but of his goodnes
 myghte thynke thee to euill
 to be stoye in his kytchen,
 thou contrariest al his mind
 to make a short tale he
 spake so sharply to her,
 that she feared that he
 wold haue beaten her. It is
 a man of asubtyll and
 wylle wytt, whyche
 wythout a vysarde is ready
 to playe anye maner of
 parte.

maner of parte. Thē this yonge wife
 what for feare, and for trouthe of the
 matter, cleane stryken oute of counte
 naunce, fell downe at her fathers fete
 Desyryng hym that he wolde forgette
 and forgiue her all that was past and
 euer after she wolde doe her duetye
 Her father forgaue her, and promised
 that she shoulde finde him a kynd and
 a louynge father, yf so be that she per-
 fourmed her promyse. xantippa. How
 dyd she afterwarde. Eulalya, whē she
 was departed frō her father she came
 backe into a chaumber, and there by
 chaunce found her husband alone she
 fel on her knees to hym and said. Mā
 in tymes paste, I neyther knewe you
 nor my selfe, from this daye froward
 ye shall se me cleane chaunged, onelye
 pardon that is past, with that her hus-
 bande toke her in his armes & kyssed
 her sayinge she shoulde lacke nothyng
 yf she wolde holde her in that mind.
 xantip. Why did she cōtinue so. Eula-
 lya. Euen tyll her endynge daye, nor
 there

Thē this yonge wife what
 for feare, and for trouthe
 of the matter, cleane
 stryken oute of
 countenaunce, fell downe
 at her fathers fete desyryng
 hym that he wolde forgette
 and forgiue her all that was
 past and euer after she
 wolde doe her duetye Her
 father forgaue her, and
 promised that she shoulde
 finde him a kynd and a
 louynge father, yf so be
 that she perfourmed her
 promyse.

xantippa. How dyd she
 afterwarde?

Eulalya, whē she was
 departed frō her father she
 came backe into a
 chaumber, and there by
 chaunce found her
 husband alone she fel on
 her knees to hym and said.
 Mā in tymes paste, I
 neyther knewe you nor my
 selfe, from this daye
 froward ye shall se me
 cleane chaunged, onelye
 pardon that is past, with
 that her husbände toke her
 in his armes & kyssed her
 sayinge she shoulde lacke
 nothyng yf she wolde
 holde her in that mind.

xantip. Why did she
cōtinue so.

there was none so vyle a thyng but
that she woulde laye handes on it redely
with all her herte, if her husband
wolde let her, so great loue was begō
and assured betwene them and many
a daye after. Shee thanked god y^e euer
she met with such a mā. For yf she had
not she sayd she had ben cleane caste a
waye. xan. We haue as greate plentie
of suche housbandes, as of white cro-
wes. Eulalya. Now, but for wering
you? I coulde tell you a thyng that
chaunced a late in this same cite. xan
typpa. I haue litell to doe, and I lyke
your communicacyon very well. Eu-
lalia. There was a certaine gentilmā
he as suche sort of men do, vsed much
hunting in the cuntry, where he hap-
pened on a younge damoyzell, a very
pore womā's child on whō he doted a
man well stryken in age, and for her
sake he lay oftē out of his owne house
his excuse was hūtig. This mā's wife
an exceeding honest womā, halfe deale
suspecte the mater, tried out her hus-
B itj bandes

Eulalya. Euen tyll her
endynge daye, nor there
was none so vyle a thyng
but that she woulde laye
handes on it redely with all
her herte, if her husband
wolde let her, so great loue
was begō and assured
betwene them and many a
daye after, shee thanked
god y^t euer she met with
such a mā. For yf she had
not she sayd she had ben
cleane caste awaye.

xan. We haue as greate
plentie of suche
housbandes, as of white
crowes.

Eulalya. Now, but for
wering you? I coulde tell
you a thyng that chaunced
a late in this same cite.

xantypa. I haue litell to
doe, and I lyke your
communicacyon very well.

Eulalia. There was a
certaine gentilmā he as
suche sort of men do, vsed
much hunting in the
cuntry, where he happened
on a younge damoyzell, a
very pore womā's child on
whō he doted a man well
stryken in age, and for her

sake he lay oftē out of his
owne house his excuse was
hūtīg. This mās wife an
exceding honest womā,
halfe deale suspecte the
mater, tried out her
husbandes falshed,

bandes falsed, on a tyme whē he had
taken his iourney fourth of the town
vnto some other waies, He wente vn
to that pooze cotage and boulded out
all the hoole matter, where he laye on
nights, wheron he drāke, what thyng
thei had to welcō him withall. There
was neither one thyng nor other, but
bare walles. ¶ His good womā retur
ned home, and sone after came againe
brynginge w^t her a good soft bed, and
al therto belongyng and certain plate
besydes that he gaue them moneye,
chargyng them that if the Gentilmā
came agayne, they shold entreate him
better not beyng knowē al this while
that he was his wyfe, but fayued her
to be her sister. Not long after her hus
band stale thether againe, he sawe the
howse otherwyse decked, and better
fare then he was wounte to haue. He
asked, frome whence commeth al this
goodly gere? They sayde that an ho
neste matrone, a kynsewoman of hys
hadde broughte it thyther and com
maunded

on a tyme whē he had
taken his iourney fourth of
the town vnto some other
waies, she wente vnto that
poore cotage and boulded
out all the hoole matter,
where he laye on nights,
wheron he drāke, what
thyng thei had to welcō
him withall. There was
neither one thyng nor other,
but bare walles. This good
womā returned home, and
sone after came againe
brynginge w^t her a good
soft bed, and al therto
belongyng and certain plate
besydes that she gaue them
moneye, chargyng them
that if the Gentilmā came
agayne, they shold entreate
him better not beyng
knowē al this while that
she was his wyfe, but
fayued her to be her sister.
Not long after her husband
stale thether againe, he
sawe the howse otherwyse
decked, and better fare then
he was wounte to haue. He
asked, frome whence
commeth al this goodly
gere? They sayde that an
honeste matrone, a
kynsewoman of hys hadde
broughte it thyther and
commaunded

maunded them that he should be well
cherished when so euer he came, by
and by his hart gaue him that it was
hys wiues dede, whan he came home
he demaunded of her yf she hadde bene
there or nay, she sayd yea. Then he as-
ked her for what purpose she sente all
that housholde stufte thither. Man
(said she) ye haue bē tenderly brought
by I perceiued that ye were but cors-
lie handled there, me thought that it
was my part, seing it was your wyll
and pleasure to be there ye should
be better loked to. Xantippa. She
was one of goddes fooles. I woulde
rather for a bed haue layd vnder him
a bundel of nettels: or a burden of thi-
stels. Eula. But here the end her hus-
bande perceyuyng the honeste of her
great pacience neuer after laye from
her, but made good cheare at home
with his owne. I am sure ye knowe
Gilberte the holāder. ran. Very well.
Eu. He (as it is not vnknowē married
an old wife in his florishig youth. Rā.

But

Her

thenm that he should be
well cherished when so
euer he came, by and by
his hart gaue him that it
was hys wiues dede, whan
he came home he
demaunded of her yf she
hadde bene there or nay,
she sayd yea. Then he
asked her for what purpose
she sente all that
housholde stufte thither.
Man (said she) ye haue bē
tenderly brought vp. I
perceiued that ye were but
corslie handled there, me
thought that it was my
part, seing it was your
wyll and pleasure to be
there ye should be better
loked to.

Xantippa. She was one of
goddes fooles. I woulde
rather for a bed haue layd
vnder him a bundel of
nettels: or a burden of
thistels.

Eula. But here the end her
husbande perceyuyng the
honeste of her great
pacience neuer after laye
from her, but made good
cheare at home with his
owne. I am sure ye knowe
Gilberte the holāder.

Xan. Very well.

Eu. He (as it is not
vnknowē married an old
wife in his florishîg youth.

aduētūre he married the good and not the woman. **Eulalia.** There sayde ye well, setting lytell stoor by hys olde wife, hunted a callette, with whom he kept much companie abroad, he dined or supped litell at home. What wouldest thou haue sayd to y^e gere. **Xantip.** What woulde I a said? I wolde haue flowē to the hores toppe and I wolde haue crowned myne husbaude at hys oute goinge to her with a pysbowle, that he so ēbawmed might haue gon vnto his souerayne ladie. **Eula.** But how much wiselier dyd this woman? She desyred that yonge woman home vnto her, and made her good chere, so by that meanes she brought home also her husband without ani witchcraft or sorserie, and yf that at anye season he supped abroad with her she would sende vnto them some good dayntie morsel, and byd him make good chere. **Xantippa.** I had leuer be slayne then I woulde be bawde vnto myne owne husbaude. **Eulalia.** Yea, but consyder
all

Xā. Per aduētūre he married the good and not the woman.

Eulalia. There sayde ye well, setting lytell stoor by hys olde wife, hunted a callette, with whom he kept much companie abroad, he dined or supped litell at home. What wouldest thou haue sayd to y^e gere.

Xantip. What woulde I a said? I wolde haue flowē to the hores toppe and I wolde haue crowned myne husbaude at hys oute goinge to her with a pysbowle, that he so ēbawmed might haue gon vnto his souerayne ladie.

Eula. But how much wiselier dyd this woman? She desyred that yonge woman home vnto her, and made her good chere, so by that meanes she brought home also her husband without ani witchcraft or sorserie, and yf that at anye season he supped abroad with her she would sende vnto them some good dayntie morsel, and byd him make good chere

Xantippa. I had leuer be
slayne then I woulde be
bawde vnto myne owne
husbande.

all thynges well, was not that muche better, then she shoulde be her shrewishnesse, haue putte her husbandes minde cleane of from her, and so haue ledde all her life in trouble and heuynesse. **Xantippa.** I graunte you well, that it was better so but I coulde not abyde it. **Eulalya.** I wyll tell you a pretty story more, and so make an ende One of oure neyghboures, a well disposed and a goddes man, but that he is some what testie, on a day pomeld his wife well and thristely aboute the pate and so good a woman as cuer was bozne, she picked her into a inner parler, and there weepyng and sobbyng, eased her heuye harte, anone after, by chaunce her husbände came into the same place, and founde hys wyfe wepyng. What sittest thou heare sayth he seighing & sobbig like a child The she like a wise woman sayde. Is it not more honesty for me to lamente my Dolours here in a secret place, the to make wondring and on oure cye
in

Eulalia. Yea, but consyder all thynges well, was not that muche better, then she shoulde be her

shrewishnesse, haue putte her husbandes minde cleane of from her, and so haue ledde all her life in trouble and heuynesse.

Xantippa. I graunte you well, that it was better so but I coulde not abyde it.

Eulalya. I wyll tell you a pretty story more, and so make an ende One of oure neyghboures, a well disposed and a goddes man, but that he is some what testie, on a day pomeld his wife well and thristely aboute the pate and so good a woman as euer was borne, she picked her into an inner parler, and there weepyng and sobbyng, eased her heuye harte, anone after, by chaunce her husbände came into the same place, and founde hys wyfe wepyng. What sittest thou heare sayth he seighing & sobbig like a child The she like a wise woman sayde. Is it not more honesty for me to lamente my dolours

here in a secret place, thē to
make wondering and on
oute crye in the strete,

in the strete, as other womē do. At so
wyfely and womanly a saing his hart
melted, promysynge her faythfullye
and truelie that he woulde neuer laye
stroke on her afterwarde, noz neuer
did. Xantippa. No more wil mine god
thanke my selfe. Eulalya. But then ye
are alwaies one at a nother, agreinge
lyke dogges and cattes. Xan. What
wouldest thou that I should do. Eu.
Fyrst & formest, whatsoeuer thy hus-
bande doeth sayde thou nothinge, for
his harte must be wonne by lytell and
littel by fayre meanes, gentilnesse and
forbearing. at the last thou shalte ey-
ther wyne him or at the leaste waie
thou shalt leade a better life thē thou
doest now. Xantippa. He his beyonde
goddes forbode, he wil neuer amende
Eulalia. Eye saye not so, there is no
beest so wild but by fayre handling be
tamed, neuer mistrust man thē. Assay
a moneth or two, blame me and thou
findest not that my counsell dooeth
case. There be some fautes wyth you
though

as other womē do. At so
wyfely and womanly a
saing his hart melted,
promysynge her faythfullye
and truelie that he woulde
neuer laye stroke on her
afterwarde, nor neuer did.

Xantippa. No more wil
mine god thanke my selfe.

Eulalya. But then ye are
alwaies one at a nother,
agreinge lyke dogges and
cattes.

Xan. What wouldest thou
that I should do?

Eu. Fyrst & formest,
whatsoeuer thy hus-
bande doeth sayde thou nothinge,
for his harte must be wonne
by lytell and littel by fayre
meanes, gentilnesse and
forbearing at the last thou
shalte eyther wyne him or
at the least waie thou shalt
leade a better life thē thou
doest now.

Xantippa. He his beyonde
goddes forbode, he wil
neuer amende.

Eulalia. Eye saye not so,
there is no beest so wild but
by fayre handling be

tamed, neuer mistrust man
thē. Assay a moneth or two,
blame me and thou findest
not that my counsell dooeth
ease. There be some fautes
wyth you thoughe

though thou se them, be wyse of this
 especyall that thou neuer gyue hym
 foule wordes in the chambre, or in bed
 but be sure that all thynges there bee
 full of pastyme and pleasure. For yf
 that place which is ordeined to make
 amēdes for all fautes and so to renew
 loue, be polluted, eyther with strife or
 grugynges, then fayre wel al hope of
 loue daies, or atonementes, yet there
 be some beastes so wayward and mis-
 cheuous, that when theyr husbandes
 hath them in their armes a bed, they
 scholde & chyde making & same plesur
 their lewd condicions (that expelseth
 all displeasures oute of their husban-
 des mynde vnpleasaunt and lytell set
 bi corrupting the medecine that shuld
 haue cured al deadly greifes, & odible
 offences. xantip. That is no newes to
 me. Eula. Though the woman shulde
 be well ware and wyse that she shulde
 neuer be disobedient vnto her husband
 yet she ought to be most circūspect that
 that

thou se them, be wyse of
 this especyall that thou
 neuer gyue hym foule
 wordes in the chambre, or
 in bed but be sure that all
 thynges there bee full of
 pastyme and pleasure. For
 yf that place which is
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 renew loue, be polluted,
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 grugynges, then fayre wel
 al hope of loue daies, or
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 some beastes so wayward
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 theyr husbandes hath them
 in their arms a bed, they
 scholde & chyde making y^t
 same plesure their lewd
 condicions (that expelseth
 all displeasures oute of
 their husbandes mynde
 vnpleasaunt and lytell set
 bi corrupting the medecine
 that shuld haue cured al
 deadly greifes, & odible
 offences.

xantip. That is no newes to
 me.

Eula. Though the woman
 shulde be well ware and
 wyse that she shulde neuer
 be disobedient vnto her

husbād yet she ought to be
most circūspect

that at meting she shew her selfe redy
and pleasaunt vnto him. xantippa.
Yea vnto a man, holde well withall
but I am combred with a beast. Eula.
No more of those wordes, most com-
monly our husbādes ar euyl through
our owne faute, but to returne againe
vnto our taile they that ar sene in the
olde fables of Poetes sai that Venus
whome they make chiefe lady of wed-
locke (hath a girdle made by the han-
dy worke of Vulcan her Lorde, and
in that is thrust al that enforceth loue
and with that she girdeth her whan
so euer she lyeth wyth her housbande
xantippa. A tale of a tubbe. Eulalya.
A tayle it is, but herke what the taile
meaneth. xantippa. Tell me. Eulalia
That techeth vs that the wyfe ought
to dyspose her selfe all that she maye
that lieng by her husbād she shew him
al the plesure that she cā. Wherby the
honest loue of matrimony may reuiue
and be renewed, & that there with be
clene dispatched al grudges & malice
can.

that at meting she shew her
selfe redy and pleasaunt
unto him.

xantippa. Yea vnto a man,
holde well withall but I am
combred with a beast.

Eula. No more of those
wordes, most commonly
our husbādes ar euyl
through our owne faute, but
to returne againe vnto our
taile they that ar sene in the
olde fables of Poetes sai
that Venus whome they
make chiefe lady of
wedlocke (hath a girdle
made by the handy worke
of Vulcan her Lorde, and in
that is thrust al that
enforceth love and with that
she girdeth her whan so
euer she lyeth wyth her
housbande

xantippa. A tale of a tubbe.

Eulalya. A tayle it is, but
herke what the taile
meaneth.

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Eulalia That techeth us that
the wyfe ought to dyspose
her selfe all the she maye
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shew him al the plesure that
she cā; Wherby the honest
love of matrimony may
reuiue and be renewed, &
that there with be clene
dispatched al grudges &
malice

xant. But how shall we come by thy gyrdle. Eula. We nede neyther wytcraft nor enchauntment, ther is non of them al, so sure as honest condiciōs accompayned with good feloshyp. xan. I can not fauoure suche an husbande as myne is. Eula. It is moste thy profyt that he be no longer suche. If thou couldest by thy Circes craft chaunge thin husband into an hogge, or a bore wouldest thou do it. xantip. God knoweth. Eu. Art thou in dout. haddest thou leauer marye an hogge than a mā. xantip. Mary I had leauer haue a manne. Eulalia. wel, what and thou couldest by sozcery make him of a drōkarde a soober man, of a vnthrifte a good housbande of an ydell losell a towarde body, wouldest thou not doe it. xantip. ycs, hardely, woulde I doe it. But where shoulde I learne the cunnyng. Eula. For soch that cōning hast thou in the if thou wouldest vtter it, thyn must he be, mauer thy head, the towarde I makest him, the better it is
for

xant. But how shall we come by the thys gyrdle?

Eula. We nede neyther wytcraft nor enchauntment, ther is non of them al, so sure as honest condiciōs accompayned with good feloshyp.

xan. I can not fauoure suche an husbande as myne is.

Eula, It is moste thy profyt that he be no longer suche. If thou couldest by thy Circes craft chaunge thin husband into an hogge, or a bore wouldest thou do it?

xantip. God knoweth.

Eu. Art thou in dout? haddest thou leauer marye an hogge than a mā.

Xantip. Mary I had leauer haue a manne.

Eulalia. wel, what and thou coudest by sorcery make him of a drōkarde a soober man, of a vnthrifte a good housbande of an ydell losell a towarde body, woldest thou not doe it?

xantip. yes, hardely,
woulde I doe it. But where
shoulde I learne the
cunnyng?

Eula. For soth that cōning
hast thou in the if thou
wouldest vtter it, thyn must
he be, mauger thy head, the
toward^e y^e makest him, the
better it is for the,

for the, thou lokest on nothing but on
 his leude cōditions, and thei make the
 half mad, thou wouldest amende hym
 and thou puttest hym farther oute of
 frame, loke rather on his good condi-
 cions, and so shalt thou make him bet-
 ter. It is to late calagayne yesterdaie
 before thou were maryed vnto hym.
 It was tyme to cōsyder what his fau-
 tes were for a woman shold not only
 take her husbände by the eyes but by
 the eares. Now it is more tyme to re-
 dresse fautes thē to fynd fautes. xantt.
 What woman euer toke her gusband
 by the eares. Eulali. She taketh her
 husbände by the eyes that loketh on
 nothyng, but on the beautye and pul-
 critude of the body. She taketh him
 by the eares, that harkeneth diligētly
 what the common voice sayth by him
 xantip. Thy counsaile is good, but it
 commeth a day after the faire. Eula.
 Yet it commeth time ynough to brin-
 ge thyne husbände to a greate sueche
 raunce to that shall bee yf God sende
 you

thou lokest on nothing but
 on his leude cōditions, and
 thei make the half mad, thou
 wouldest amende hym and
 thou puttest hym farther
 oute of frame, loke rather on
 his good condicions, and so
 shalt thou make him better.
 It is to late calagayne
 yesterdaie before thou were
 maryed unto hym. It was
 tyme to cōsyder what his
 fautes were for a women
 shold not only take her
 husbände by the eyes but by
 the eares. Now it is more
 tyme to redresse fautes thē
 to fynd fautes.

xantt. What woman euer
 toke her gusband by the
 eares.

Eulali. She taketh her
 husbände by the eyes that
 loketh on nothyng, but on
 the beautye and pulcritude
 of the body. She taketh him
 by the eares, that harkeneth
 diligētly what the common
 voice sayth by him

xantip. Thy counsaile is
 good, but it commeth a day
 after the faire.

Eula. Yet it commeth time
 ynough to bringe thyne

husbande to a greate
furtheraunce to that shall
bee yf God sende you anie
frute together.

you ante frute together. xantippa. We
 are spede alre dy of tha. Eulaly. How
 longe ago. Xantip. A good whyle ago
 Eulalia. How many monethes old is
 it. Xantip. It lacketh lytle of. vii. Eula
 What a tale is this, ye reken the mo-
 nethes by nightes and dayes double.
 xantippa. Not so. Eula. It can not be
 none other wyse, yf ye reken from the
 mariage day. xantippa. yea, but what
 thē, I spake with him befoze we were
 married. Eulalia. Be children gotten
 by speakinge. xantip. It befell so that
 he mette me alone and begon to ticke
 at me, and tickled me vnder the arme
 holes and sydes to make me laugh. I
 might not awaie with ticklynge, but
 fell downe backwarde vpon a bedde
 and he a losfe, neuer leuynge kysynge
 on me, what he did els I can not saye,
 but by sayncte Marie within a while
 after my bely beganne to swell. Eula.
 Go now and dispraye thyne husbāde
 whiche yf he gette children by playe,
 what wyl he do whē he goeth to it in
 good

xantippa. We are spede
 alre dy of that.

Eulaly. How long ago.

Xantip. A good whyle ago

Eulalia. How many
 monethes old is it.

Xantip. It lacketh lytle of.
 vii.

Eula What a tale is this, ye
 reken the monethes by
 nightes and dayes double.

Xantippa. Not so.

Eula. It can not be none
 other wyse, yf ye reken
 from the mariage day.

xantippa. yea, but what thē,
 I spake with him before we
 were married.

Eulalia. Be children gotten
 by speakinge.

xantip. It befell so that he
 mette me alone and begon
 to ticke at me, and tickled
 me vnder the arme holes
 and sydes to make me
 laugh. I might not awaie
 with ticklynge, but fell
 downe backwarde vpon a
 bedde and he a losfe, neuer

leuinge kyssynge on me,
what he did els I can not
saye, but by sayncte Marie
within a while after my bely
beganne to swell.

Eula. Go now and disprayse
thine husbāde whiche yf he
gette children by playe,
what wyll he do whē he
goeth to it in good earnest.

good earnest. xantippa, I fere me I am
 payed agayn. Eula. Good locke God
 hath sent a fruitfull grounde, a good
 tylmā. xantip. In that thing he might
 haue lesse laboure and moze thanke.
 Eula. Few wyues finde at theyr hus-
 bandes in that behalfe but were ye thē
 sure together. xanti. yea that we were
 Eula. The offence is the lesse. Is it a
 man chylde. xantip. yea. Eula. He shal
 make you at one so that ye wil bow &
 forbere. What saieth other mē by thin
 husband, they that be his cōpanions,
 they delite with him abroad xā. They
 say that he is meruelous gentyl, redy
 to do euery man pleasure, liberal and
 sure to his frende. Eula. And that put-
 teth me in good cōfort that he wyll be
 ruled after our counsayll. xantip. But
 I fynde him not so. Eula. Order thy
 selfe to him as I haue tolde thee, and
 cal me no moze true sayer but a liar, if
 he be not so good vnto the as to anie
 creature liuinge Agayne cōsidze this
 he is. yet but a childe, I thinke he pas-
 seth

xantippa, I fere me I am
 payed agayn.

Eula. Good locke God hath
 sent a fruitfull grounde, a
 good tylmā.

Xantip. In that thing he
 might haue lesse laboure
 and more thanke.

Eula. Few wyues finde at
 theyr husbandes in that
 behalfe but were ye thē sure
 together.

xanti. yea that we were

Eula. The offence is the
 lesse. Is it a man chylde.

xantip. yea.

Eula. He shal make you at
 one so that ye wil bow &
 forbere. What saieth other
 mē by thin husband, they
 that be his cōpanions, they
 delite with him abroad

xā, They say that he is
 meruelous gentyl, redy to
 do euery man pleasure,
 liberal and sure to his
 frende.

Eula. And that putteth me
 in good cōfort that he wyll

be ruled after our
counsayll.

xantip. But I fynde him
not so.

Eula. Order thy selfe to
him as I haue tolde thee,
and cal me no more true
sayer but a lier, if he be not
so good vnto the as to anie
creature liuinge Again
cōsidre this he is yet but a
childe, I thinke he passethe
not.

seeke not. xxiiij. the blacke oxe neuer
trode on hys fote, nowe it is but losse
laboure to reckon vpon anye deuorse:
xantippa. Yet manye a tyme and ofte
I haue troubled my braynes withal
Eulalia. As for that fantasie whenso
euer it commeth into your mynd first
of all counte how naked a thyng a wo
man is, deuorsed from man. It is the
hyghest dignitie that longethe to the
wyfe to obsequyous vnto her spouse.
So hath nature ordeined so god hath
apoynted, that the woman shoulde be
ruled al by the man loke onely vpon
this whiche is trouthe, thine husbnde
he is, other canste thou none haue. A
gaine forgette not that swete babe be
gotten of both your bodies what thin
beste thou to do with that, wilt thou
take it awaye with thee? Thou shalt
bereue thyne husband his ryght wyll
thou leue it with hym? thou shalt spoile
le thy self of thy cheefeste Jewell thou
haste. Beside all this tell mee truely
hast thou none euill wyllers, Besyde

Et

all

xxiiij. the blacke oxe neuer
trode on hys fote, nowe it
is but losse laboure to
reckon vpon anye deuorse.

xantippa. Yet manye a
tyme and ofte I haue
troubled my braynes
withal

Eulalia. As for that
fantasie whensoever it
commeth into your mynd
first of all counte how
naked a thyng a woman is,
deuorsed from man. It is
the hyghest dignitie that
longethe to the wyfe to
obsequyous vnto her
spouse. So hath natyre
ordeined so god hath
apoynted, that the woman
shoulde be ruled al by the
man loke onely vpon this
whiche is trouthe, thine
husbnde he is, other
canste thou none haue.

Againe forgette not that
swete babe be gotten of
both your bodies what thin
beste thou to do with that,
wilt thou take it awaye
with thee? Thou shalt
bereue thyne husband his
ryght wyll thou leue it
with hym? thou shalt
spoil thy self of thy
cheefeste Jewell thou haste.

Beside all this tell me
trueth hast thou none euyll
wyllers, Besyde all thys
tell me trueth, hast thou
none euyll wyllers.

all thyng tell me trueth, hast thou none
 euill wyllers. **xan.** I haue a stepdame
 I warrant you, and myne husbandes
 mother euen such another. **Eula.** Do
 they hate the so deadly. **xantip.** They
 woulde se me hanged. **Eula.** Thē for-
 get not thē what greater plesure coul-
 dest thou shew them then to se the de-
 uorsed from thine husband and to led
 a wydowes lyfe. Yea and worse thē a
 wydow, for wydowes be at their choi-
 se. **xantippa.** I holde well with youre
 counsell, but I can not awaye wyth the
 paynes. **Eulalia.** yet reckon what paines
 ye toke or ye colde teache your pa-
 ret to speake. **xantippa.** Exceedynge
 much. **Eu.** And thinke you much to la-
 bour a lytel in refozming your husbād
 with whō you may liue merely all the
 dayes of your lyfe. What busines doe
 we put thē self to be wel & easily horsed
 & what we think our selues to good to
 take paines that we mai haue our hus-
 bandes gētil & curteise vnto vs. **xantip.**
 What shal I do. **Eu.** I haue told you
 all

xan. I haue a stepdame I
 warrant you, and myne
 husbandes mother euen
 such another.

Eula. Do they hate the so
 deadly.

xantip. They woulde se
 me hanged.

Eula. Thē forget not thē
 what greater plesure
 couldest thou shew them
 then to se the deuorsed
 from thine husband and to
 led a wydowes lyfe. Yea
 and worse thē a wydow,
 for wydowes be at their
 choise.

xantippa. I holde well
 with youre counsell, but I
 can not awaye with the
 paynes.

Eulalia. yet reckon what
 paines ye toke or ye colde
 teache your paret to
 speake.

xantippa. Exceedynge
 much.

Eu. And thinke you much
 to labour a lytel in
 refozming your husbād
 with whō you may liue

merely all the dayes of
your lyfe. What busines
doe mē put thē self to be
wel & easly horsed & shal
we think our selues to
good to take paines that we
mai haue our husbādes
gētil & curteise vnto vs.

xantip. What shal I do.

al redy, se that al thing be clene & trim
 at home, that no sluttysch or vnclenlye
 syghtes dryue hym oute a dores. Be
 your selfe alwayes redy at a becke, be
 ryng continuall in minde what reue
 rēce the wife oweth vnto her husbād.
 Be neyther in your dūpes, nor alway
 es on your mery pinnes go nether to
 homely nor to nycely. Let your meat
 be cleane dresed, you know your hus
 bādes diet. What he loueth best that
 dresse. Moreouer shewe your selfe lo
 uinge and fayre spokē vnto thē where
 he loueth, call them now and thē vn
 to your table. At meate, se that al thin
 ges be well sauored, and make good
 chere, And whē that he is toppe heuy
 playing on his lute, sytte thou by and
 singe to him so shalte thou make hym
 keepe home, and lessen hys expences
 This shall he thynke at length, in fay
 the I am a fonde felowe that maketh
 suche chere with a strumpet abroode
 with greate lossee bothe of substance
 and name, seying that I haue a wyfe

¶

¶

Eu. I haue told you al redy,
 se that al thing be clene &
 trim at home, that no
 sluttysch or vnclenlye
 syghtes dryue hym oute a
 dores. Be your selfe
 alwayes redy at a becke,
 beryng continuall in
 minde what reuerēce the
 wife oweth vnto her
 husbād. Be neyther in your
 dūpes, nor alwayes on your
 mery pinnes go nether to
 homely nor to nycely. Let
 your meat be cleane
 dressed, you know
 yourhusbādes diet. What he
 loueth best that dresse.
 Moreouer shewe your selfe
 louinge and fayre spokē
 vnto thē where he loueth,
 call them now and thē vnto
 your table. At meate, se
 that al thinges be well
 sauored, and make good
 there, And whē that he is
 toppe heuy playing on his
 lute, sytte thou by and
 singe to him so shalte thou
 make hym keepe home,
 and lessen hys expences
 This shall he thynke at
 length, in faythe I am a
 fonde felowe that maketh
 suche chere with a strumpet
 abroode with greate lossee
 bothe of substance and

name, seyng that I haue a
wyfe

at home bothe muche fayrer, and one
that loueth me ten times better, with
whome I may be both clenlyer recei-
ued and dayntelier cherisshed xantip.
Beleuest thou that it will take and I
put it into a profe. Eulali. Looke on
me. I warrante it or ought longe I
wyll in hande with thyne husbände, &
I will tell hym his parte. xantippa. ye
marie that is well sayde. But be wyse
that he espie not our casse, he would
plaie his fages, all the house should be
to lytle for hym. Eulalia. Take no
thought. I shall so conuey my mat-
ters, that he shall dysclose all toge-
ther hym selfe, what busynesse is be-
twene you, that done I wyll handell
him pretelie as I thinke beste, and I
truste to make him a new man for the
and when I se my time I wyl make a
lie for thee, how louinge thou hast spo-
ken of him. xantippa. Chryst speede vs
and bringe our pupose well aboute.
Eulalia. He will not fayle the so thou
do thy good wyll

There

at home bothe muche
fayrer, and one that loueth
me ten times better, with
whome I may be both
clenlyer receiued and
dayntelier cherisshed

xantip. Beleuest thou that
it will take and I put it into
a profe.

Eulali. Looke on me. I
warrante it or ought longe I
wyll in hande with thyne
husbände, & I will tell hym
his part.

xantippa. ye marie that is
well sayde. But be wyse
that he espie not our casle,
he would plaie his fages,
all the house should be to
lytle for hym.

Eulalia. Take no thought.
I shall so conuey my
matters, that he shall
dysclose all together hym
selfe, what busynesse is
betwene you, that done I
wyll handell him pretelie
as I thinke beste, and I
truste to make him a new
man for the and when I se
my time I wyl make a lie
for thee, how louinge thou
hast spoken of him.

xantippa. Chryst spede vs
and bringe our pupose well
about.

Eulalia. He will not fayle
the so thou do thy good
wyll.

There was a man that married a woman whiche hadde great riches and beawtye. Howe bee it he hadde suche an impedymment of nature that he was domme and coulde not speake, whiche thyng made him ryghte pensyfe, and sayd, wherfore vpon a daye as he walked alone ryght heuye in hearte thynkyng vpon his wyfe. There came one to hym and asked him what was the cause of his heuynesse whiche answered that it was onely bycause his wife was borne dome. To whome this other said I shal shewe the soone a remedy and a medycyne (therfore that is thus) go tak an aspen leafe and lay it vnder her tōge this night wher bringe a sleape, and I warrant the that shee shall speake on the morowe whiche man beyng glad of thys medycyne prepared therfore and gathered aspen leaues, wherfore he layd thre of them vnder her tonge whan shee was a sleape. And on the

Cij morow

There was a man that married a woman whiche hadde great riches and beawtye. Howe bee it she hadde suche an impedymment of nature that she was domme and coulde not speake, whiche thyng made him ryghte pensyfe, and sayd, wherfore vpon a daye as he walked alone ryght heuye in hearte thynkyng vpon his wyfe. There came one to hym and asked him what was the cause of his heuynesse whiche answered that it was onely bycause his wife was borne dome. To whome this other said I shal shewe the soone a remedy and a medycyne (therfore that is thus) go tak an aspen leafe and lay it vnder her tōge this night shee beinge a sleape, and I warrant the that shee shall speake on the morowe whiche man beyng glad of thys medycyne prepared therfore and gathered aspen leaues, wherfore he layd thre of them vnder her tonge whan shee was a sleape.

And on the morow when he him selfe awaked, he
Desyrous to know how hys medicine
wrought being in bed with her, he de-
maunded of her how she did, and sode-
ly she answered and sayd, I beshrewe
thy harte for waking me so early, and
so by the vertue of that medycyne she
was restored to her speche. But in cō-
clusion her spech encreased day by day
and she was so curst of cōdycon that
euery daie she brauled and chyd with
her husbände, so muche at the laste he
was more weped, and had much more
trouble and disease wyth her shrewed
wordes then he hadde before whē she
was dumme; wherfore as he walked
another tyme alone he happened to
mete agayne with the same personne
that taught hym the sayde medycine
and sayde to hym thys wyse. Syr ye
taught me a medicin but late to make
my domme wyfe to speake, byddyng
me lay an Aspen leafe vnder her toug
when she sleapte, and I layde three
Aspen leaues there. Wherfore now
she

And on the morow when he
him selfe awaked he
Desyrous to know how hys
medicine wrought being in
bed with her, he demaunded
of her how she did, and
sodely she answered and
sayd, I beshrewe thy harte
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so by the vertue of that
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and chyd with her husbände,
so muche at the laste he was
more weped, and had much
more trouble and disease
wyth her shrewed wordes
then he hadde before whē
she was dumme, wherfore
as he walked another tyme
alone he happened to mete
agayne with the same
personne that taught hym
the sayde medycine and
sayde to hym thys wyse. Syr
ye taught me a medicin but
late to make my domme
wyfe to speake, byddyng
me lay an aspen leafe vnder
her toug when she sleapte,
and I layde three Aspen
leaves there.

He speaketh. But yet **She** speaketh soo much & so shrewdlye that I am more wrier of her now, then I was when she was dōme: Wherfore I praie you teache me a medycine to modyfye her that she speake not so muche. This other answered and sayd thus. Sir I am a deuyl of hel, but I am one of thē that haue least power here. Al be yet I haue power to make a womā to speke, but and yf a woman begin ones to speake, I nor al the deuyls in hel that haue the mooste power be not able to make a woman to be styll, nor to cause her to leue her speakyng.

The end of this pleasant dialogue declaryng the seuerall properties of & two contrary disposers of the wyues aforesayde.

Imprynted at London in Paules church yearde, at the sygne of the Sunne, by Antony Kytson.

Wherfore nowe she speaketh. But yet she speaketh soo much & so shrewdlye that I am more wrier of her now, then I was when she was dōme: Wherfore I praie you teache me a medycine to modyfye her that she speake not so muche. This other answered and sayd thus. Sir I am a deuyl of hel but I am one of thē that haue least power there. Al be yet I haue power to make a womā to speake, but and yf a woman begin ones to speake, I nor al the deuyls in hel that haue the mooste power be not able to make a woman to be styll, nor to cause her to leue speakyng.

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*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A MERRY
DIALOGUE DECLARINGE THE PROPERTIES OF SHROWDE
SHREWS AND HONEST WIVES ***

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